

India. Their popularity is evident from the number of views their channel gets, the likes on their videos and even the attendance at their offline events. They boast of a subscriber base of 2.7 million currently, and their numbers only seem to increase with every passing day. It should come as no surprise then that they found it fitting to start selling AIB labeled merchandise. Their members are often seen sporting the merchandise in videos.

The t-shirts, for instance, they sell have quotes from their popular videos/shows or even cheesy Bollywood lines that are sure to get people laughing. The official AIB merchandise is a fabulous way of them making money beyond the digital space; and the way they use the digital space to sell the merchandise makes this as interesting aspect of the online crossing into the offline realm.

A number of companies are even popping up to serve the niche of YouTube influencers alone. These companies will create branded merchandise for you to sell through your YouTube channel. They may also use their own YouTube channels to advertise the same. If your audience relates to your content, they will be highly likely to invest in products that you are creating exclusively for them. This might have a more positive impact than you creating sponsored or branded content for them.

Crowdfunding future projects:

Now this is a supremely interesting aspect of being a YouTube. There are a zillion examples of YouTube influencers who have used their channels to help crowdfund their future projects. So whether you need a new studio to keep making those amazing experimental sculptures or need money to book a studio to record portions of that short film, let your viewers decide if you are worth their money. If you have been providing good, engaging, original content; chances are they will want to see more of it.

You can shoot a short video to show the audience what to expect from your next project. A popular example of a crowdfunding project gone right is a short film called Kung Fury, which pays homage to the popular 80s film by the same name. The project requirement was 2 million dollars but people kept paying long after that limit had been met. The final amount collected was well over 6 million dollars. That meant production values could be better, better actors could be hired, better locations chosen, better props, better everything! Now wouldn't that be amazing? To have fans pay for content that they want you to create because they believe in your product.